

NIRMAAN MODEL UNITED NATIONS 2026

AIPPM

AGENDA:

Deliberation on whether 'One Nation, One Election' framework strengthens democratic governance or enables the monopolization of political power.

1. COMMITTEE OVERVIEW

The All India Political Parties Meet (AIPPM) simulates Indian political discourse. Unlike traditional UN committees, delegates represent Indian political parties and debate within the framework of Indian constitutional law and parliamentary procedure.

This format requires understanding of party ideologies, coalition dynamics, and India's federal structure. Delegates should be prepared for spirited debate, points of order, and real-time coalition building.

2. UNDERSTANDING THE AGENDA

'One Nation, One Election' (ONOE) proposes synchronizing Lok Sabha and all State Legislative Assembly elections to be held simultaneously. This was the norm from 1951-1967 before the cycle was disrupted by premature dissolutions.

HISTORICAL CONTEXT:

- 1951-1967: First four general elections held simultaneously with state elections
- 1968-69: Premature dissolution of several state assemblies broke the cycle
- 1999: Law Commission of India (170th Report) first recommended exploring simultaneous elections
- 2018: Law Commission (Draft Report) examined the issue in detail
- 2023: High-Level Committee chaired by former President Ram Nath Kovind constituted
- December 2024: Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill introduced in Lok Sabha
- Bill referred to Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC) for detailed examination

3. ARGUMENTS IN FAVOUR

COST REDUCTION:

- India spent approximately Rs. 55,000-60,000 crore on the 2019 general elections alone
- Frequent state elections multiply these costs significantly
- Savings for both government (election machinery) and political parties (campaigning)

GOVERNANCE EFFICIENCY:

- Model Code of Conduct (MCC) halts policy decisions during election periods
- With staggered elections, some part of India is perpetually under MCC restrictions
- Simultaneous elections would allow uninterrupted governance for full 5-year terms

REDUCED VOTER FATIGUE:

- Constant elections may contribute to declining voter turnout in some states
- Consolidation could improve participation and engagement

SECURITY DEPLOYMENT:

- Elections require massive deployment of Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs)
- Simultaneous polls would free security forces for regular duties
- Estimated 10 million personnel deployed for election security nationwide

KOVIND COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATIONS:

- Two phases: First synchronize Lok Sabha + State Assemblies, then local body elections within 100 days
- Constitutional amendments to Articles 83, 85, 172, 174, and 356
- Fixed five-year terms with provisions for mid-term scenarios

4. ARGUMENTS AGAINST

THREAT TO FEDERALISM:

- National issues would overshadow state-specific concerns in simultaneous campaigns
- State autonomy undermined when local issues get sidelined
- DMK, TMC, and other regional parties strongly oppose on federal grounds

IMPACT ON REGIONAL PARTIES:

- National parties with larger resources and media presence would dominate
- Regional parties fear reduced visibility in national-level campaign noise
- Could lead to homogenization of India's diverse political landscape

CONSTITUTIONAL CONCERNS:

- Parliamentary system allows for no-confidence motions and mid-term dissolutions
- Fixed terms conflict with the principle of government accountability
- Would require at least 5 Constitutional amendments and ratification by half of state legislatures

ACCOUNTABILITY DEFICIT:

- Fewer elections mean fewer opportunities for voters to express dissatisfaction
- Anti-incumbency, a crucial democratic corrective, would be weakened
- 5-year gap between elections reduces government responsiveness

PRACTICAL CHALLENGES:

- 96.8 crore registered voters, 10.5 lakh polling stations would need to be operational simultaneously
- Requirement of additional Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) and VVPATs
- Post-delimitation, potentially 888 Lok Sabha constituencies + 4,000+ state assembly seats

5. PARTY POSITIONS

BJP (RULING): Strongly supports ONOE, introduced the Constitutional Amendment Bill

CONGRESS (INC): Opposes, calls it "anti-federal" and "anti-democratic"

DMK: Strongly opposes, views it as threat to Tamil Nadu's state autonomy

TMC: Opposes, Mamata Banerjee calls it "assault on federalism"

AAP: Cautiously critical, concerns about implementation

BJD/YSRCP: Have shown some support for the concept

LEFT PARTIES (CPI, CPI(M)): Strongly oppose, call it "destruction of parliamentary democracy"

JD(U)/TDP: Part of NDA, tentative support with reservations

Note: Delegates must research their assigned party's specific position and argue accordingly.

6. RECOMMENDED READINGS

- Kovind Committee Report on Simultaneous Elections (2024) · Available at legislative.gov.in
- Law Commission of India, 170th Report (1999) and Draft Report (2018)
- Election Commission of India Annual Reports
- M.P. Jain, "Indian Constitutional Law" (Latest Edition) · Chapters on Legislature
- Granville Austin, "Working a Democratic Constitution" · For historical context
- Articles 83, 85, 172, 174, 324, and 356 of the Indian Constitution
- Representation of the People Act, 1950 and 1951